

# Alexander John Noles

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**Portfolio** <https://alexandernoles.github.io/>

*Three Penny Piece  
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## Personal profile

I am an enthusiastic and artistic, young game developer, seeking a position in the game development industry that I can use to gain further practical experience.

I have experience in all parts of game development, from coding to sound design but especially with C# and Unity. In 2022, during my gap year, I released a solo project, called “Dash and Slash”, on the Steam Store. I went out of my way, during development of “Dash and Slash”, to create everything myself (including music, sound effects and art).

During my final year of university, I focused my dissertation on emergent narratives and how gameplay influences storytelling. Accordingly, I created a prototype of a simulation-driven RTS game, that borrowed heavily in style from games such as Kenshi and Stellaris. There is a large focus placed on the code side structure of simulations, in particular how to keep them flexible and expandable. I received a 78 for the report itself, a strong first-class grade. Overall, I received an Upper Second classification for the work done during my degree.

Most of my hobby and university work is stored on my Github, including my dissertation. A guide to its content can be found at the bottom of my portfolio.

## Core Skills

- **C#** (9.0 using Visual Studio on .Net 2.1)
- **Unity** (2022.3.x and 2020.3.x)
  - i) **Scripting** (Simulations, Behaviours, Generation)
  - ii) **Editor Tooling**
  - iii) **Shader Graph** (14.0.8)
  - iv) **Burst Compiler and Jobs**
- **Java** (JDK 23)
- **Python** (3.5.x and 3.11.x)
- **HLSL** (Direct3D 9 Style, primarily in Unity)
- **Aseprite** (1.3.13)
- **Blender** (2.7.6 to 4.4.3)
- **HTML** (HTML5)
- **CSS** (3.01+)
- **JavaScript** (ECMAScript 2020)

## Supporting/Additional Skills

- **Git and Github** (Windows PowerShell 5.1)
- **Vue.js** (3.5.x)
- **SQL** (SQLite3)
- **Godot** (4.3+)
- **Amazon Web Services**
- **Jira**
- **LaTeX** (report writing, including my dissertation)
- **Microsoft Office 2024:** (Word, Excel, PowerPoint)
- **WHILE Language**
- **Lab Chirp** (1.60)
- **C++** (Used mostly in the context of Unreal)
- **Unreal** (Used for only a few projects)

## Degree

**2022–2025: BSc (Hons) Computer Science, 2:1, University of Sussex**

Key modules include:

- **Software Engineering**  
*A group project module focused on recreating the board game RISK digitally. Allowed me to readily apply my game development knowledge in an academic setting.*
- **Further Programming**  
*A first year module that focused on the organization of programs and general principles of good software design.*

- Program Analysis  
*Enhanced my skill set in understanding the cost of programs and how to properly compare the quality of programs in a practical environment.*
- Limits of Computation  
*Taught me the limits of computation, with a focus on specific undecidable programs and methods for proving decidability.*
- Web 3D Applications  
*A practical focused module, centred around creating a 3D model showcase website. Allowed me to further practice my modelling skills, gaining further confidence in them.*
- Compilers And Computer Architecture  
*Focusing on the very fundamentals of how computers worked. The module helped solidify a proper foundation for all the rest of my knowledge, contextualizing it.*

### **Other Game Development Interests**

- Game Jams:  
Timed game making competitions, that can vary greatly in scale and target genre, they almost always have a theme. So far, I have taken part in 16 and submitted to 12, typically in a small team. My gap year project was originally one of these submissions.
- Pixel-Art:  
I started doing Pixel-Art in 2019 as part of my very first game jam. Since then, I have used and improved my skills in many projects, including my released video game, “Dash and Slash”.
- Shader coding:  
I made a concerted effort to improve at visual work and technical artistry during my first year of university. This involved creating several smaller visual projects and coding a basic 3D renderer. I’ve utilized these skills continuously throughout my game development work since learning them.
- 3D Modelling:  
I’ve been using blender on and off for 7+ years, utilizing it in a variety of game jams, my Final Year Project and of course my module “Web 3D Applications”. I began using blender more consistently about a year ago.

### **Additional Education**

#### **2014 – 2021 Farmors School**

A Levels: Computer Science (A), Maths (B), Physics (C).

Received a certificate from my school for my effort and enthusiasm in Computer Science and Physics specifically.

GCSEs: 11 subjects, grades A – C, including Maths, English, Photography, Spanish and Computer Science

### **Work experience**

March 2022 – September 2022: Shop Assistant, Londis

- Worked doing a variety of different things, from shelf stacking to cleaning.
- Developed effective communication skills to assist customers both while working on the tills and on the shop floor.
- Helped train newer shop assistants, in all aspects of the job.

January 2022 – July 2022: Solo game developer

- Worked alone, requiring me to learn effective time management.
- Filled a large range of roles, gaining experience in every aspect of game development, from the beginning of the process to release.

September 2021 – January 2022: Kitchen Porter, Jack’s Café and Restaurant

- Worked effectively in a high stress environment, alongside co-workers.
- Developed the skills to keep my workspace in good condition, including maintenance on cleaning equipment.
- Assisted the chefs/other staff members with their cleaning and preparation duties.
- Was forced to leave in early January due to a health condition caused by the hot and cramped environment.

2018: School Work experience, St James's Place

- Introduced to and helped with a variety of roles over the course of a week.
- Gained experience working in a proper workplace and learned how to better present myself.

### **Voluntary experience**

Late 2019: Village clean up, Poulton

- Assisted with a community effort to remove litter from our village.

References available on request.